Valuing Internal Communication

How communication creates value

Drawing on a review of more than 60 research and industry reports, this webinar considers how internal communication creates value for organizations and employees. The evidence discussed links effective internal communication with organizational performance, alignment, culture, engagement and change. It can help people understand priorities, coordinate work, contribute to innovation and navigate change. It also shapes relationships, trust and employees' experience of the organization.

The session cautions against reducing value to the volume of content produced or to a single productivity measure. Communication contributes alongside leadership, operations and other organizational factors; it should not claim sole responsibility for outcomes. The practitioner discussion illustrates the value of connecting communication to decisions and measurable outcomes, such as whether a change is understood and implemented with fewer obstacles.

Planning, measurement and evaluation are recurring themes. Practitioners may need to look across several indicators and consider broader patterns rather than relying on one survey question or channel metric. The report also frames internal communication as relationship-building, not only channel management and content distribution.

What this means for practice

- Start with the organizational or employee outcome communication is intended to support.
- Explain the contribution of communication without overstating causality.
- Evaluate a combination of relevant indicators, including understanding, behavior, employee experience and operational outcomes where appropriate.
- Include employee value, such as feeling informed, engaged and empowered, alongside organizational value.

The webinar's message is that value is strongest when communication is planned around a real purpose and evaluated with evidence, rather than assumed from activity alone.

Source: "Valuing Internal Communication" transcript.